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VEHICLE DOOR PINCH DETECTION SYSTEM AND METHOD WITH IMPROVED DETECTION PERFORMANCE

Abstract

A vehicle door pinch detection method includes a door closure request step in which a controller determines whether there is a request to close a vehicle door, a rainy weather determination step in which the controller determines whether it is rainy weather or non-rainy weather by the rain detection sensor provided at a weather strip, a door closure initiation step in which the controller loads a pinch threshold and starts actuating the door motor for closing the vehicle door; and a pinch determination step in which the controller determines whether there occurs a pinch by the pinch sensors provided on the weather strips, wherein the controller loads different pinch thresholds in response to a rainy weather or a non-rainy weather, and if the pinch is detected in the pinch determination step, the controller opens the door.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION

[0001] The present application claims priority to Korean Patent Application No. 10-2024-0029171, filed on Feb. 28, 2024, the entire contents of which is incorporated herein for all purposes by this reference.

BACKGROUND OF THE PRESENT DISCLOSURE

Field of the Present Disclosure

[0002] The present disclosure relates to a vehicle door pinch detection system and method to detect pinching of an occupant's body while closing of the door and more particularly, to a vehicle door pinch detection system and method in which detection sensitivity is adjusted in case of rain to eliminate poor detection and improve detection performance.

Description of Related Art

[0003] Anti-pinch sensors are provided on a vehicle door to detect pinching of an occupant's body or belongings between a vehicle door being closed and a vehicle body, or between the vehicle doors when the occupant gets in or out of the vehicle.

[0004] The anti-pinch sensors are typically provided inside a weather strip provided around a periphery of the vehicle door, so that in the event of a pinch, the weather strip is first deformed and then the anti-pinch sensors detect a deformation of the weather strip and therefore an occurrence of the pinch.

[0005] Purpose built vehicles (PBVs) that operate based on autonomous driving are expected to be utilized as passenger transportation vehicles. As the PBVs are operated without a driver, there is a need to increase a reliability of the in-vehicle safety systems.

[0006] For example, a pinch occurring upon the door closing needs to be detected very precisely in the absence of the driver to avoid unnecessary malfunctions and safety accidents.

[0007] In a rainy weather, the anti-pinch sensors may malfunction due to direct contact with moisture or high humidity. In other words, in spite of no pinch situation, frequent false detection of the pinch due to malfunctions of the anti-pinch sensors results in repeated door opening and closing, which delays a departure of the vehicle and prevents the vehicle from moving quickly.

[0008] The information included in this Background of the present disclosure is only for enhancement of understanding of the general background of the present disclosure and may not be taken as an acknowledgement or any form of suggestion that this information forms the prior art already known to a person skilled in the art.

BRIEF SUMMARY

[0009] Various aspects of the present disclosure are directed to providing a vehicle door pinch detection system and method which are configured for detecting a pinch of a vehicle door while adopting different pinch thresholds for a rainy or non-rainy weather, preventing malfunction and improving detection performance.

[0010] Another objective of the present disclosure is to provide a vehicle door pinch detection

system and method in which, when a pinch or a touch occurs on a vehicle door, an occupant is informed of the pinch or touch through an alarm and the vehicle door is reopened to prevent injury to the occupant, improving detection performance.

[0011] An aspect of the present disclosure may provide a vehicle door pinch detection system with improved detection performance, the system including: an internal pinch sensor configured for detecting a pinch at a periphery of a vehicle door (“a door”) provided on one side of a vehicle during a closing operation; a rain detection sensor provided separately from the internal pinch sensor and configured for detecting a rainy weather; and a controller operatively connected to the internal pinch sensor and rain detection sensor and configured to determine whether a current weather is rainy weather or non-rainy weather based on an output of the rain detection sensor, to load different pinch thresholds in response to a rainy weather or a non-rainy weather, and determine an occurrence of the pinch if the output of the internal pinch sensor is equal to or greater than the pinch thresholds.

[0012] The controller may set a pinch threshold for the non-rainy weather to be higher than a pinch threshold for the rainy weather.

[0013] The internal pinch sensor and the rain detection sensor may transmit respective output values depending on a change in impedance, and the controller may compare the output values of the internal pinch sensor and the rain detection sensor with preset values to determine a body's pinching or approaching or rainy weather.

[0014] The internal pinch sensor and the rain detection sensor may be mounted on an internal weather strip of the vehicle.

[0015] The system may further include an external pinch sensor operatively connected to the controller and provided on an external weather strip to detect a pinch depending on a change in resistance value upon an occupant's pinch.

[0016] The controller may include: a rain detection controller configured to receive an output value from the rain detection sensor and control the rain detection sensor; an internal pinch controller configured to receive an output value from the internal pinch sensor and control the internal pinch sensor; and an external pinch controller configured to receive an output value from the external pinch sensor and control the external pinch sensor.

[0017] The controller may be connected to a door controller to control an opening or a closing of the vehicle door.

[0018] The door controller may be connected to a door button that outputs an operation signal when opening of the door is required, and to an alarm means that alarms when opening or closing of the door is completed.

[0019] The controller may be configured to, upon detection of the body's pinching or approaching around the periphery of the door during closing of the door, increase a count, and if the increased count is below a predetermined count threshold, request the door controller to open the door for a predetermined time period and then close the door again.

[0020] Another aspect of the present disclosure provides a method of detecting a pinch in a vehicle door with improved detection performance, the method including steps performed by a controller: determining whether there is a vehicle door closing request; determining whether it is rainy weather or non-rainy weather by a rain detection sensor provided on a weather strip; initiating closure of the door, by the controller, by loading a pinch threshold and actuating a door motor to close the door; and determining, whether there occurs a pinch by a pinch sensor provided on the weather strip, wherein the controller loads different pinch thresholds depending on whether it is rainy weather or non-rainy weather, and if the pinch is detected in the pinch determination step, the controller is configured to open the door.

[0021] If it is determined to be rainy weather in the rainy weather determination step, a pinch threshold for the rainy weather may be loaded.

[0022] If it is determined to be non-rainy weather in the rainy weather determination step, a pinch

threshold for the non-rainy weather may be loaded.

[0023] The pinch threshold for the rainy weather may be set higher than the pinch threshold for the non-rainy weather.

[0024] In the door closure initiation step, the controller may be configured to reset the count, wherein the method further includes steps performed by the controller: if the pinch is detected in the pinch determination step, increasing the count; determining whether the increased count has reached a predetermined count threshold at which the controller stops the control operation; and if the count is below the count threshold in the increased count determination step, temporarily opening the door and then closing the door again after a predetermined time period.

[0025] The method may further include steps performed by the controller: if the count is determined to have reached the count threshold in the increased count determination step, opening the door for interruption of the control operation; determining whether the opening of the door has been completed; and if the opening of the door has been completed, stopping an actuation of the door motor and alarming that the actuation of the door motor has been stopped.

[0026] The rain detection sensor may be mounted on an internal weather strip of the vehicle.

[0027] The pinch sensor may include an internal pinch sensor provided on the internal weather strip to detect the occupant's pinching or approaching by a change in impedance, and an external pinch sensor provided on an external weather strip to detect the occupant's pinching by a change in resistance value upon the occupant's pinching.

[0028] The method may further include the step performed by the controller: if it is determined that no pinching is detected in the pinch determination step, determining whether a closing of the door has been completed, and if it is determined that the closing of the door has been completed, the controller may be configured to stop the actuation of the door motor and alarm the stopping of the actuation of the door motor.

[0029] According to the vehicle door pinch detection system and method including the above-mentioned configurations with improved detection performance, a pinch may be detected on an external side of the vehicle by an external sensor in a resistive-detection type and on an internal side of the vehicle by an internal sensor in an impedance-detection type.

[0030] the rainy or non-rainy weather may be detected by an impedance-detective manner, and according to a weather condition, a body detection level of the sensor may be varied to eliminate detection defects.

[0031] Furthermore, if the body's pinch or touch is detected, the door is opened and an alarm is triggered so that the occupants may recognize the pinch or touch and then avoid injuries.

[0032] The methods and apparatuses of the present disclosure have other features and advantages which will be apparent from or are set forth in more detail in the accompanying drawings, which are incorporated herein, and the following Detailed Description, which together serve to explain certain principles of the present disclosure.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0033] FIG. 1 is a side diagram illustrating a vehicle including a vehicle door pinch detection system with improved detection performance according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure;

[0034] FIG. 2 is a cross-sectional diagram taken along line I-I of FIG. 1;

[0035] FIG. 3 is a perspective diagram seen from an outside of the vehicle in which an external weather strip and an internal weather strip are provided at the rear door with an external sensor and an internal sensor of the vehicle door pinch detection system according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure;

[0036] FIG. 4 is a perspective diagram seen from the interior of the vehicle in which an external weather strip and an internal weather strip are provided at the rear door with an external sensor and an internal sensor of the vehicle door pinch detection system according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure;

[0037] FIG. 5 is a cross-sectional diagram illustrating a state in which the external sensor of the vehicle door pinch detection system according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure is provided on the external weather strip;

[0038] FIG. 6 is a cross-sectional diagram illustrating a state in which the internal sensor of the vehicle door pinch detection system according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure is provided on the internal weather strip;

[0039] FIG. 7 is a block diagram illustrating the vehicle door pinch detection system according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure;

[0040] FIG. 8 is a graph illustrating a distribution of measured values in selecting parameters for determining whether it is rainy weather or non-rainy weather in the vehicle door pinch detection system according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure;

[0041] FIG. 9 is a graph illustrating a distribution of measured values in selecting parameters for determining whether a vehicle door is pinched in rainy weather and non-rainy weather in the vehicle door pinch detection system according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure; and

[0042] FIG. 10 is a flowchart illustrating a vehicle door pinch detection method with improved detection performance according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0043] It may be understood that the appended drawings are not necessarily to scale, presenting a somewhat simplified representation of various features illustrative of the basic principles of the present disclosure. The specific design features of the present disclosure as included herein, including, for example, specific dimensions, orientations, locations, and shapes will be determined in part by the particularly intended application and use environment.

[0044] In the figures, reference numbers refer to the same or equivalent portions of the present disclosure throughout the several figures of the drawing.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0045] Reference will now be made in detail to various embodiments of the present disclosure(s), examples of which are illustrated in the accompanying drawings and described below. While the present disclosure(s) will be described in conjunction with exemplary embodiments of the present disclosure, it will be understood that the present description is not intended to limit the present disclosure(s) to those exemplary embodiments of the present disclosure. On the other hand, the present disclosure(s) is/are intended to cover not only the exemplary embodiments of the present disclosure, but also various alternatives, modifications, equivalents and other embodiments, which may be included within the spirit and scope of the present disclosure as defined by the appended claims.

[0046] Hereinafter, a vehicle door pinch detection system and method with improved detection performance according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure will be described in detail with reference to the accompanying drawings.

[0047] FIG. 1 illustrates an example of a vehicle 1 including a vehicle door (“a door”) pinch detection system with improved detection performance according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure. The present disclosure may be applied to a vehicle 1 in which a pair of doors 11 and 12 are slidably provided. The present disclosure may be applied to the vehicle 1, such as a purpose-built vehicle (PBV) between a front door 11 and a rear door 12.

[0048] In the vehicle 1 illustrated in FIG. 1, the front door 11 may slidably open toward a front of the vehicle 1 (in a leftward direction in FIG. 1) and the rear door 12 may slidably open toward a rear of the vehicle 1 (in a rightward direction in FIG. 1), wherein the vehicle door pinch detection system of the present disclosure is provided to detect a pinch between the front door 11 and the rear

door **12**. Of course, the vehicle door pinch detection system may also be applied to a vehicle in which the doors are opened or closed in a swinging manner to detect a pinch between the vehicle door and the vehicle body.

[0049] FIG. **2** is a cross-sectional diagram taken along line I-I of FIG. **1**. An external pinch sensor **22** and an internal pinch sensor **25** for detecting a pinch between the front door **11** and the rear door **12** may be provided on an external weather strip **21** and an internal weather strip **23**, respectively.

[0050] The front door **11** and the rear door **12** may include door panels **11a** and **12a** as base door frames mounted on door trims **11b** and **12b** as finishing materials on the internal side of the vehicle **1**.

[0051] The external weather strip **21** and the internal weather strip **23** may be provided on any one of the front door **11** or the rear door **12** to provide a sealing between the front door **11** and the rear door **12** when both the front door **11** and the rear door **12** are closed.

[0052] For example, as illustrated in FIG. **3** and FIG. **4**, the external weather strip **21** and the internal weather strip **23** may be provided on the front end portion of the rear door **12** so that the external weather strip **21** is fitted on the external side of the front end portion of the rear door **12** and the internal weather strip **23** is fitted on the internal side of the front end portion of the rear door **12**. Thus, the external weather strip **21** and the internal weather strip **23** may seal the external and internal sides, respectively, of the vehicle **1** between the rear end portion of the front door **11** and the front end portion of the rear door **12**.

[0053] The external pinch sensor **22** may be integrally formed on the external weather strip **21**.

[0054] The external weather strip **21** may include a first fixing portion **21a** fixedly fitted to one side of the door **11** or **12**, a first insert **21b** inserted into an interior of the first fixing portion **21a**, a first hollow sealing portion **21c** formed on an external side of the first fixing portion **21a** to abut against the body or the other door **12** or **11** of the vehicle **1**, a first hollow sensor portion **21d** formed to be connected to the first sealing portion **21c** from the external side of the first fixing portion **21a**, and a bridge portion **21e** formed between the first sealing portion **21c** and the first sensor portion **21d** to separate the first sealing portion **21c** and the first sensor portion **21d**.

[0055] The external pinch sensor **22** may be provided on the internal side of the first sensor portion **21d**. The external pinch sensor **22** may be a contact-type sensor which is configured to detect a pinch by a variable resistance occurring when two spaced apart members **22a** and **22b** are brought into contact.

[0056] The first member **22a** and the second member **22b** forming the external pinch sensor **22** may be provided spaced apart from each other on the internal surface of the first sensor portion **21d**. The first member **22a** and the second member **22b** may be formed of a conductive rubber material, and when the first and second members come into contact with each other due to pinching, the pinch may be detected through a difference in voltage generated by a change in resistance in a circuit connected to the external pinch sensor **22**. The circuit for detecting pinching through the external pinch sensor **22** may include two resistors connected in parallel, wherein one of the resistors is connected in series with the external pinch sensor **22**. In the instant case, current normally may flow only through one resistor, but when a pinch occurs, current flows through both resistors, causing the resistance of the entire circuit to change, resulting in a voltage difference, which indicates the occurrence of the pinch.

[0057] The internal pinch sensor **25** may be integrally formed on the internal weather strip **23**.

[0058] The internal weather strip **23** may include a second fixing portion **23a** fixedly fitted to the door **11** or **12**, a second insert **23b** inserted into an interior of the second fixing portion **23a**, a second hollow sealing portion **23c** formed on an external side of the second fixing portion **23a** to abut against the body or the other door **12** or **11** of the vehicle **1**, a second sensor portion **23d** formed to protrude from the second fixing portion **23a** at a distance from the second sealing portion **23c**.

[0059] The internal pinch sensor **25** may be formed on the second sensor portion **23d**.

[0060] Furthermore, a rain detection sensor **24** may also be formed on the second sensor portion **23d**.

[0061] Looking at the arrangement of the internal pinch sensor **25** and the rain detection sensor **24** from the internal weather strip **23**, the rain detection sensor **24** may be disposed on the internal side of the vehicle than the internal pinch sensor **25**.

[0062] The internal pinch sensor **25** and the rain detection sensor **24** may be provided as an impedance-detective sensor or the like that detects the user's touch on a flat screen or the like.

[0063] Accordingly, when the occupant's body is approaching the internal pinch sensor **25** or is pinched around a portion where the internal pinch sensor **25** is provided, the impedance value may change so that the pinch is detected.

[0064] On the other hand, if the rain droplets are approaching the rain detection sensor **24** due to rainy weather, the impedance value may also change, so that the controller **30** may determine whether it is rainy weather or non-rainy weather.

[0065] In an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, the controller **30** may determine whether a current weather is rainy weather or non-rainy weather.

[0066] When the impedance type sensor is applied as the internal pinch sensor **25** or the rain detection sensor **24**, the impedance type sensor may have a high frequency band so that the output value varies depending on an object in contact with the sensor, allowing the pinch of the occupant's body or the rainy weather to be detected discriminately.

[0067] The controller **30** may monitor the statuses of the external pinch sensor **22**, the internal pinch sensor **25**, and the rain detection sensor **24**, and determine the pinch or approaching of the occupant's body through the external pinch sensor **22** and the internal pinch sensor **25**, as well as whether it is rainy weather or non-rainy weather through the rain detection sensor **24**. In other words, the controller **30** may include an external pinch controller **31**, an internal pinch controller **33**, and a rain detection controller **32** that receive output values from and control the external pinch sensor **22**, the internal pinch sensor **25**, and the rain detection sensor **24** through communication therewith.

[0068] In the controller **30**, a rainy weather determination threshold $P_{sub.weather}$ for determining the rainy weather may be stored in advance. As illustrated in FIG. 8, the rainy weather determination threshold $P_{sub.weather}$ may be set by use of the ADC value obtained through an analog digital converter by converting a voltage value or current value measured by the rain detection sensor **24** in the actual rainy weather situation and the non-rainy weather situation. For example, the arithmetic mean of the minimum ADC value in rainy weather and the maximum ADC value in non-rainy weather may be set as the rainy weather determination threshold $P_{sub.weather}$.

[0069] Accordingly, the controller **30** may be configured to determine that when the output value of the rain detection sensor **24** is higher than the rainy weather determination threshold $P_{sub.weather}$, the weather is the rainy weather, and when the output value of the rain detection sensor **24** is lower than the rainy weather determination threshold $P_{sub.weather}$, the weather is the non-rainy weather.

[0070] On the other hand, FIG. 9 shows an example of setting a pinch determination threshold for determining whether there is a pinch in the rainy weather or the non-rainy weather.

[0071] The rainy weather pinch threshold $P_{sub.Rainy}$ may be set to the minimum value of the ADC values converted from the values measured by the internal pinch sensor **25** in rainy weather.

[0072] The non-rainy weather pinch threshold $P_{sub.Sunny}$ may also be set to the minimum value of the ADC values converted from the values measured by the internal pinch sensor **25** in non-rainy weather.

[0073] Therefore, the controller **30** may be configured to determine whether it is rainy weather or non-rainy weather depending on the rainy weather determination threshold $P_{sub.weather}$, and if it is rainy, determine that there is the body's pinch or approaching at a position where the internal pinch sensor **25** is provided with the rainy weather pinch threshold $P_{sub.Rainy}$. Furthermore, in the case of non-rainy weather, the controller **30** may be configured to determine that there is the body's

pinch or approaching at a position where the internal pinch sensor **25** is provided with the non-rainy weather pinch threshold P.sub.Sunny.

[0074] The controller **30** may be connected to a door controller **40** that is configured to control the opening and closing of the doors **11** and **12**.

[0075] The controller **30** may output to the door controller **40** an indication that the body's pinch or approaching has occurred around the periphery of the door **11** or **12**, and the door controller **40** may control the door **11** or **12** accordingly. The door controller **40** may also output to the controller **30** a closing signal of the door **11** or **12** to detect the body's pinch or approaching.

[0076] The door controller **40** may be connected to a door button **41** that outputs an operation signal when the opening of the door **11** or **12** is required, and an alarm means **43**, such as a buzzer, a display, a lamp, or the like, that alarms the situation when the opening or closing of the door **11** or **12** is completed. Furthermore, the door controller **40** may be configured for controlling a door motor **42** which operates the opening and closing of the door **11** or **12**. For example, the door motor **42** may be controlled by the door controller **40** in a pulse width modulation (PWM) manner.

[0077] In the controller **30**, a vehicle door pinch detection method to be described later may be stored in a logic, which, together with the door controller **40**, may be performed by the controller to detect a pinch around the periphery of the door **11** or **12**.

[0078] FIG. **10** illustrates a vehicle door pinch detection method with improved detection performance according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0079] The vehicle door pinch detection method with improved detection performance according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure may include: a door closure request step **S112** in which the controller **30** determines whether there is a request to close the door **11** or **12**; a rainy weather determination step **S120** in which the controller **30** determines whether it is rainy weather or non-rainy weather by the rain detection sensor **24** provided on the weather strip **21** or **23**; and a closure initiation step **S131** or **S132** in which the controller **30** loads a pinch threshold P.sub.Rainy or P.sub.Sunny and starts actuating the door motor **42** for closing the door **11** or **12**; and a pinch determination step **S142** in which the controller **30** determines whether there is a pinch by the pinch sensors **22** and **25** provided on the weather strips **21** and **23**, wherein the controller **30** loads different pinch thresholds P.sub.Rainy and P.sub.Sunny depending on whether it is rainy weather or non-rainy weather, and if the pinch is detected in the pinch determination step **S142**, the controller **30** opens the door **11** or **12**.

[0080] The power supply determination step **S111** may determine whether the vehicle **1** is supplied with power by a driving or starting device. The controller **30** may be configured to determine whether power is being applied to various devices necessary for performing the vehicle door pinch detection method according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure. For example, when the vehicle **1** becomes Accessory (ACC) ON before KEY ON for driving so that power is applied to the external pinch sensor **22**, the internal pinch sensor **25**, the rain detection sensor **24**, and the like, the sensors may transmit the power application status to the controller **30**. When power is applied to respective components for carrying out the present disclosure, the controller **30** may proceed to the next step.

[0081] In the door closure request step **S112**, the controller **30** may be configured to determine whether there is an occupant's request to close the doors **11** or **12**. When the door button **41** provided on the interior of the vehicle **1** is manipulated by the occupant so that the manipulation signal is input to the controller **30**, the controller **30** may be configured to determine that there is a request for closing the door **11** or **12** of the vehicle **1** and proceed to the next step. On the other hand, the request for closing the door **11** or **12** may be transmitted to the controller **30** not only via the door button **41** but also via an external terminal. For example, an external administrator may control the vehicle **1** via a terminal such as a smartphone. In the instant case, when the vehicle **1** is stopped at a station or the like, the opening and closing of the door **11** or **12** may be controlled through the terminal, which may mean that there is a request to close the door **11** or **12**.

[0082] If either the power supply determination step S111 or the door closure request step S112 is not satisfied, the controller 30 may return to the power supply determination step S111 to cause the logic to be performed again from the beginning of the flowchart.

[0083] In the rainy weather determination step S120, the controller 30 may be configured to determine whether it is rainy weather or non-rainy weather by the rain detection sensor 24 provided on the internal weather strip 23. The internal weather strip 23 may be provided with the rain detection sensor 24, which is normally energized with a high frequency current to detect the rain droplets or the body's approaching by a change in impedance. The controller 30 may be configured to determine whether it is rainy weather or non-rainy weather by the signal input from the rain detection sensor 24.

[0084] In the closure initiation steps S131 and S132, the controller 30 may load the pinch threshold P.sub.Rainy or P.sub.Sunny depending on whether it is rainy weather or non-rainy weather and start actuating the door motor 42 for closing the door 11 or 12. The controller 30 may load the pre-stored pinch threshold P.sub.Rainy or P.sub.Sunny and start actuating the door motor 42 for closing the door 11 or 12.

[0085] If it is rainy weather, the controller 30 may load the rainy weather pinch threshold P.sub.Rainy and perform the rainy weather closure initiation step S131 to actuate the door motor 42.

[0086] On the other hand, if it is a non-rainy weather, the controller 30 may load the non-rainy weather pinch threshold P.sub.Sunny and performs the non-rainy weather closure initiation step S132 to actuate the door motor 42.

[0087] Here, the rainy weather pinch threshold P.sub.Rainy may be set higher than the non-rainy weather pinch threshold P.sub.Sunny.

[0088] When the rainy weather closure initiation step S131 or the non-rainy weather closure initiation step S132 is performed, a count N, which is the number of times the body's pinch or approaching is detected at the door 11 or 12, may be reset. That is, when the rainy weather closure initiation step S131 or the non-rainy weather closure initiation step S132 is performed, the count N may become 0 (zero).

[0089] After the rainy weather closure initiation step S131 or the non-rainy weather closure initiation step S132, the controller 30 may perform a pinch monitoring step S141 to monitor whether the body's pinch or approaching occurs with the signal from the external pinch sensor 22 or the internal pinch sensor 25.

[0090] In the pinch determination step S142, the controller 30 may be configured to determine whether there is a pinch with the signal from the pinch sensors 22 and 25 mounted on the weather strips 21 and 23.

[0091] If the controller 30 detects the body's pinch or approaching via the external pinch sensor 22 or the internal pinch sensor 25, the controller 30 may perform a temporary opening step S150 to open the door 11 or 12, and after a predetermined time period, close the door 11 or 12 again. Since the pinch or approaching has been detected at the door 11 or 12, to prevent injury or an accident, the controller 30 may open the door 11 or 12, which was being closed, and after a predetermined time period, starts closing the door 11 or 12 again. By temporarily opening the door 11 or 12 for the predetermined time period via the temporary opening step S150, the occupant may move away his body or belongings from the door 11 or 12.

[0092] After the temporary opening step S150, the controller 30 may return to the pinch monitoring step S141.

[0093] On the other hand, if the body's pinch or approaching is continuously repeated at the door 11 or 12, which may indicate that there is another problem, a count increasing step S143 and an increased count determination step S144 may be performed between the pinch determination step S142 and the temporary opening step S150.

[0094] That is, the count increasing step S143 increases the count N each time the controller 30

may detect the body's pinch or approaching in the pinch determination step **S142**.

[0095] The increased count **N** in the count increasing step **S143** may be compared by the controller **30** with a count threshold in the increased count determination step **S144**. That is, in the increased count determination step **S144**, the controller **30** may be configured to determine whether the increased count **N** has reached a predetermined count threshold at which the controller **30** stops the control operation. Normally, if the body's pinch or approaching occurs temporarily upon closing of the door **11** or **12**, the body's pinch or approaching may be resolved in the temporary opening step **S150**. However, if the body's pinch or approaching continues to occur so that the count **N** reaches the count threshold **N**, then there may be a problem with the entire system, so a further pinch monitoring operation is not required.

[0096] Therefore, when the count **N** reaches the count threshold, the controller **30** may perform a door opening step **S161** to open the door **11** or **12** to interrupt the control.

[0097] In the door opening step **S161**, the controller **30** may actuate the door motor **42** to open the door **11** or **12**.

[0098] Accordingly, the controller **30** may perform an opening completion determination step **S162** to determine whether the opening of the door **11** or **12** is completed, until the opening of the door **11** or **12** is completed.

[0099] In a motor stopping step **S180**, when the opening of the door **11** or **12** is completed, the controller **30** may stop actuating the door motor **42**, and alarms the stopping of the door motor **42**. Since there is no need for the door motor **42** to operate when the opening of the doors **11** or **12** is completed, the operation of the door motor **42** may be stopped. Furthermore, the stopping of the door motor **42** may be alarmed by a buzzer **43**, a display or a lamp or the like provided on the vehicle **1** through sound, text, lighting manner, or the like. On the other hand, if the motor stopping step **S180** is performed after the opening completion determination step **S162**, the case may indicate that the door **11** or **12** is abnormally opened, which needs to be alarmed for the occupant or the manager to recognize the situation.

[0100] On the other hand, if it is determined that no pinch has been detected in the pinch determination step **S142**, the controller **30** may be configured to perform a closing completion determination step **S170** to determine whether the closing of the door **11** or **12** is completed.

[0101] If the closing of the door **11** or **12** is completed in the closing completion determination step **S170**, the controller **30** may stop the actuation of the door motor **42**, and performs a motor stopping step **S180** to alarm the stopping of the door motor **42**.

[0102] Here, when the motor stopping step **S180** is performed after the closing completion determination step **S170**, the door **11** or **12** may be normally opened, so that the case is alarmed differently than when the motor stopping step **S180** is performed after the opening completion determination step **S162**.

[0103] For example, in the case of alarming with sound, alarming may be performed with a different sound, or in the case of alarming with text or lamp, alarming may be performed with a different text or lighting manner.

[0104] Furthermore, the term related to a control device such as "controller", "control apparatus", "control unit", "control device", "control module", "control circuit", or "server", etc refers to a hardware device including a memory and a processor configured to execute one or more steps interpreted as an algorithm structure. The memory stores algorithm steps, and the processor executes the algorithm steps to perform one or more processes of a method in accordance with various exemplary embodiments of the present disclosure. The control device according to exemplary embodiments of the present disclosure may be implemented through a nonvolatile memory configured to store algorithms for controlling operation of various components of a vehicle or data about software commands for executing the algorithms, and a processor configured to perform operation to be described above using the data stored in the memory. The memory and the processor may be individual chips. Alternatively, the memory and the processor may be

integrated in a single chip. The processor may be implemented as one or more processors. The processor may include various logic circuits and operation circuits, may be configured for processing data according to a program provided from the memory, and may be configured to generate a control signal according to the processing result.

[0105] The control device may be at least one microprocessor operated by a predetermined program which may include a series of commands for carrying out the method included in the aforementioned various exemplary embodiments of the present disclosure.

[0106] The aforementioned invention can also be embodied as computer readable codes on a computer readable recording medium. The computer readable recording medium is any data storage device that can store data which may be thereafter read by a computer system and store and execute program instructions which may be thereafter read by a computer system. Examples of the computer readable recording medium include Hard Disk Drive (HDD), solid state disk (SSD), Silicon Disk Drive (SDD), read-only memory (ROM), random-access memory (RAM), CD-ROMs, magnetic tapes, floppy discs, optical data storage devices, etc and implementation as carrier waves (e.g., transmission over the Internet). Examples of the program instruction include machine language code such as those generated by a compiler, as well as high-level language code which may be executed by a computer using an interpreter or the like.

[0107] In various exemplary embodiments of the present disclosure, each operation described above may be performed by a control device, and the control device may be configured by a plurality of control devices, or an integrated single control device.

[0108] In various exemplary embodiments of the present disclosure, the memory and the processor may be provided as one chip, or provided as separate chips.

[0109] In various exemplary embodiments of the present disclosure, the scope of the present disclosure includes software or machine-executable commands (e.g., an operating system, an application, firmware, a program, etc.) for enabling operations according to the methods of various embodiments to be executed on an apparatus or a computer, a non-transitory computer-readable medium including such software or commands stored thereon and executable on the apparatus or the computer.

[0110] In various exemplary embodiments of the present disclosure, the control device may be implemented in a form of hardware or software, or may be implemented in a combination of hardware and software.

[0111] Software implementations may include software components (or elements), object-oriented software components, class components, task components, processes, functions, attributes, procedures, subroutines, program code segments, drivers, firmware, microcode, data, database, data structures, tables, arrays, and variables. The software, data, and the like may be stored in memory and executed by a processor. The memory or processor may employ a variety of means well known to a person having ordinary knowledge in the art.

[0112] Furthermore, the terms such as “unit”, “module”, etc. included in the specification mean units for processing at least one function or operation, which may be implemented by hardware, software, or a combination thereof.

[0113] In the flowchart described with reference to the drawings, the flowchart may be performed by the controller or the processor. The order of operations in the flowchart may be changed, a plurality of operations may be merged, or any operation may be divided, and a predetermined operation may not be performed. Furthermore, the operations in the flowchart may be performed sequentially, but not necessarily performed sequentially. For example, the order of the operations may be changed, and at least two operations may be performed in parallel.

[0114] Hereinafter, the fact that pieces of hardware are coupled operatively may include the fact that a direct and/or indirect connection between the pieces of hardware is established by wired and/or wirelessly.

[0115] In an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, the vehicle may be referred to as

being based on a concept including various means of transportation. In some cases, the vehicle may be interpreted as being based on a concept including not only various means of land transportation, such as cars, motorcycles, trucks, and buses, that drive on roads but also various means of transportation such as airplanes, drones, ships, etc.

[0116] For convenience in explanation and accurate definition in the appended claims, the terms “upper”, “lower”, “inner”, “outer”, “up”, “down”, “upwards”, “downwards”, “front”, “rear”, “back”, “inside”, “outside”, “inwardly”, “outwardly”, “interior”, “exterior”, “internal”, “external”, “forwards”, and “backwards” are used to describe features of the exemplary embodiments with reference to the positions of such features as displayed in the figures. It will be further understood that the term “connect” or its derivatives refer both to direct and indirect connection.

[0117] The term “and/or” may include a combination of a plurality of related listed items or any of a plurality of related listed items. For example, “A and/or B” includes all three cases such as “A”, “B”, and “A and B”.

[0118] In exemplary embodiments of the present disclosure, “at least one of A and B” may refer to “at least one of A or B” or “at least one of combinations of at least one of A and B”. Furthermore, “one or more of A and B” may refer to “one or more of A or B” or “one or more of combinations of one or more of A and B”.

[0119] In the present specification, unless stated otherwise, a singular expression includes a plural expression unless the context clearly indicates otherwise.

[0120] In the exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, it should be understood that a term such as “include” or “have” is directed to designate that the features, numbers, steps, operations, elements, parts, or combinations thereof described in the specification are present, and does not preclude the possibility of addition or presence of one or more other features, numbers, steps, operations, elements, parts, or combinations thereof.

[0121] According to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, components may be combined with each other to be implemented as one, or some components may be omitted.

[0122] The foregoing descriptions of specific exemplary embodiments of the present disclosure have been presented for purposes of illustration and description. They are not intended to be exhaustive or to limit the present disclosure to the precise forms disclosed, and obviously many modifications and variations are possible in light of the above teachings. The exemplary embodiments were chosen and described in order to explain certain principles of the invention and their practical application, to enable others skilled in the art to make and utilize various exemplary embodiments of the present disclosure, as well as various alternatives and modifications thereof. It is intended that the scope of the present disclosure be defined by the Claims appended hereto and their equivalents.

Claims

1. A vehicle door pinch detection system with improved detection performance, the system comprising: an internal pinch sensor configured for detecting a pinch at a periphery of a vehicle door provided on one side of a vehicle during a closing operation; a rain detection sensor provided separately from the internal pinch sensor and configured for detecting a rainy weather; and a controller operatively connected to the internal pinch sensor and the rain detection sensor and configured to determine whether a current weather is rainy weather or non-rainy weather based on an output of the rain detection sensor, to load different pinch thresholds in response to the rainy weather or the non-rainy weather, and to determine an occurrence of the pinch in response that the output of the internal pinch sensor is equal to or greater than the pinch thresholds.
2. The vehicle door pinch detection system of claim 1, wherein in loading the different pinch thresholds, the controller is further configured to set a pinch threshold for the non-rainy weather to be higher than a pinch threshold for the rainy weather.

3. The vehicle door pinch detection system of claim 1, wherein the internal pinch sensor and the rain detection sensor transmit respective output values depending on a change in impedance, and the controller is further configured to compare the output values of the internal pinch sensor and the rain detection sensor with preset values to determine a body's pinching or approaching or the rainy weather.
4. The vehicle door pinch detection system of claim 1, wherein the internal pinch sensor and the rain detection sensor are mounted on an internal weather strip of the vehicle.
5. The vehicle door pinch detection system of claim 1, further including an external pinch sensor operatively connected to the controller and provided on an external weather strip to detect a pinch depending on a change in resistance value upon an occupant's pinch.
6. The vehicle door pinch detection system of claim 5, wherein the controller includes: a rain detection controller configured to receive the output from the rain detection sensor and control the rain detection sensor; an internal pinch controller configured to receive an output from the internal pinch sensor and control the internal pinch sensor; and an external pinch controller configured to receive an output from the external pinch sensor and control the external pinch sensor.
7. The vehicle door pinch detection system of claim 1, wherein the controller is connected to a door controller to control an opening or a closing of the vehicle door.
8. The vehicle door pinch detection system of claim 7, wherein the door controller is connected to a door button that outputs an operation signal in response that the opening of the vehicle door is required, and to an alarm means that alarms in response that the opening or the closing of the vehicle door is completed.
9. The vehicle door pinch detection system of claim 7, wherein the controller is further configured to, upon detection of a body's pinching or approaching around the periphery of the vehicle door during the closing of the vehicle door, increase a count, and in response that the increased count is below a predetermined count threshold, request the door controller to open the vehicle door for a predetermined time period and then close the vehicle door again.
10. A method of detecting a pinch in a vehicle door with improved detection performance, the method comprising the steps: determining, by a controller, whether there is a vehicle door closing request; determining, by the controller, whether a current weather is rainy weather or non-rainy weather by a rain detection sensor provided on a weather strip and operatively connected to the controller; initiating, by the controller, closure of the vehicle door by loading a pinch threshold and actuating a door motor operatively connected to the controller to close the vehicle door; and determining, by the controller, whether there occurs a pinch by a pinch sensor provided on the weather strip and operatively connected to the controller, wherein the controller loads different pinch thresholds depending on whether the current weather is the rainy weather or the non-rainy weather, and in response that the pinch is detected in the determining of whether there occurs the pinch, the controller is further configured to open the vehicle door.
11. The method of claim 10, wherein in the loading of the different pinch thresholds in response to concluding that the current weather is the rainy weather, the controller is further configured to load a pinch threshold for the rainy weather.
12. The method of claim 10, wherein in response to concluding that the current weather is the non-rainy weather, the controller is further configured to load a pinch threshold for the non-rainy weather.
13. The method of claim 10, wherein in the loading of the different pinch thresholds, a pinch threshold for the rainy weather is set higher than a pinch threshold for the non-rainy weather.
14. The method of claim 10, wherein in the initiating of the closure of the vehicle door, the controller is further configured to reset a count, and wherein the method further includes steps performed by the controller: in response that the pinch is detected, increasing the count; determining whether the increased count has reached a predetermined count threshold at which the controller stops control operation; and in response that the count is below the predetermined count

threshold, opening the vehicle door and then closing the vehicle door again after a predetermined time period.

15. The method of claim 14, further including steps performed by the controller: in response to concluding that the count has reached the predetermined count threshold, opening the vehicle door for interruption of the control operation; determining whether the opening of the vehicle door has been completed; and in response to concluding that the opening of the vehicle door has been completed, stopping an actuation of the door motor and alarming that the actuation of the door motor has been stopped.

16. The method of claim 10, wherein the rain detection sensor is mounted on an internal weather strip of the vehicle.

17. The method of claim 16, wherein the pinch sensor includes: an internal pinch sensor provided on the internal weather strip to detect an occupant's pinching or approaching by a change in impedance; and an external pinch sensor provided on an external weather strip to detect the occupant's pinching by a change in resistance value upon the occupant's pinching.

18. The method of claim 16, further including the step performed by the controller: in response to concluding no pinching is detected, determining whether a closing of the vehicle door has been completed, and wherein in response to concluding that the closing of the vehicle door has been completed, the controller is further configured to stop the actuation of the door motor and alarm the stopping of the actuation of the door motor.
